

before they are married, this piece of advice is particularly crucial: *Ladies, don't let him take you for an idiot. You must get a prenuptial agreement before you get married, regardless of your financial situation, especially if you own a business.* An ex-spouse, especially a vengeful one, can mire your business in the kind of legal drama that could completely bankrupt you. People will be unemployed, livelihoods will be destroyed, all because you were too shy to talk about money on a date. Think about it this way: If you can't talk about money, what other important subjects are off-limits? What to do in the event of illness? How you want to raise your kids? Whether you'd ever consider working and living abroad? Seriously, if you can't talk about money, how are you going to talk about topics that are even more sensitive?

Used to be, prenups were the purview of rich old men on their second or third wives, men who wanted to protect themselves against gold diggers after them only for their money. (I address this tricky topic in detail in Part Four.) But prenuptial agreements are not just for rich, older people anymore. Anyone coming into a relationship with any assets, any savings, any investments, however small, needs to get one. In fact, I can't think of a relationship that wouldn't benefit from financial clarity and protection. Remember, anything can happen. Even if both spouses come into a marriage with next to nothing, a windfall could occur later on that changes everything. So I want you to think of a prenup as *possible insurance against probable change*. You may never need it, but when the crap hits the fan, you're going to be very happy you had that difficult conversation.

Money Mistake: Prenup Is a Dirty Word

THE FIX: PRACTICE SAYING IT—OUT LOUD

Prenups are often criticized for being unromantic. That is because they are. They have nothing whatsoever to do with love—only with money. But there's an upside to introducing a prenup into your burgeoning relationship. You get to see what your partner's like during